

TAB 17



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-345-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 4/21/2026

In Control: School Operations

Renaming of San Fernando Middle School

Division of School Operations

Brief Description:

(Renaming of San Fernando Middle School) Recommends approval of renaming the school to San Fernando Academy.

Action Proposed:

Approval of the renaming of San Fernando Middle School consistent with BUL-5549.2 (Naming/Renaming Schools, Buildings, and Fields). This school is in Board District 6, Region North.

Background:

In accordance with District policy, the school completed the required steps of the school's renaming process with documentation provided to the Division of School Operations. The renaming committee was established in September 2025. To ensure all voices were heard, the committee included teachers, parents, students, and community partners to ensure a diverse range of perspectives throughout the process.

San Fernando Middle School has been meeting with the school community to discuss the renaming since September 2025. Prior to the renaming, the school underwent consolidation of SFMS and SfiAM. The school community has been working to establish a new school identity since May 2024. Once the school merged, votes were completed, the committee quickly began the process the voting on the new school's name. While honoring the legacy and importance of the City of San Fernando, the committee would like the school's name to reflect a new image. Beyond the school's location of being nestled in the City of San Fernando, the school has also been deemed a historic site by the city. The school is focused on rebuilding an image to reflect the quality learning experiences. Commitment to expanding innovative learning opportunities for students, including the development of a dual immersion program, a farm-to-table sustainability initiative, and a robust arts program. The name San Fernando Academy therefore honors the schools' past while clearly signaling the exciting academic direction of our school's future. As a result, there was a strong consensus that the school's name should reflect these expanded opportunities available to students.

The selected name is to retain and honor the City of San Fernando while representing the dynamic and creative academic program offered. Changing the name will enhance the school's identity, better communicate the school's educational mission, and support efforts to increase student enrollment by accurately showcasing the full range of opportunities available at the school.

The renaming committee proposed three (3) names: San Fernando Academy, San Fernando Learning Academy, and San Fernando Legacy Academy.

Expected Outcomes:

The school and community voted to change the name and merge San Fernando Middle School to San Fernando

Academy.

Board Options and Consequences:

If the Board of Education votes “Yes”, the name of the school will change to San Fernando Academy.

If the Board of Education votes “No”, the name of the school will remain San Fernando Middle School.

Policy Implications:

None

Budget Impact:

The total estimated cost to update the school's name across three locations (the front-entrance, marquee, and exterior mural) is \$50,000. Funding for this project has been fully identified and will be covered through the school's General Fund (3027). In the future, the school will work with partners to fundraise to continue updating the gymnasium mural at a future date.

Student Impact:

Renaming the school would have a positive community impact. With a new name, the school will be reimagined to incorporate a direct academic rigor while creating a welcoming and safe environment for all students.

Equity Impact:

Non-Applicable

Issues and Analysis:

None

Below is the breakdown of the voting that took place:

School Staff Votes:

Below is the breakdown of the voting that took place. There was a total of 329 collected ballots.

Proposed School Names	Students	%	Staff	%	Parents	%	Total
San Fernando Academy	95	43.18 %	18	24%	19	58%	132
San Fernando Learning Academy	46	20.09%	33	43%	4	12%	83
San Fernando Legacy Academy	79	35.09%	25	33%	10	30%	114
TOTAL	220		76		33		329

Attachments:

None

Submitted:

04/09/26

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ANDRES E. CHAIT
Acting Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent
Business Services & Operations

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

✓ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


DEBRA BRYANT
Interim Chief of School Operations
Division of School Operations

REVIEWED BY:


KURT E. JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

✓ Approved as to budget impact statement.